

AI-Driven Blockchain System for Proactive Cyber Threat Detection

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Abstract—The increasingly advanced nature of cyber threats, especially the zero-day exploits and the advanced persistent threats, makes the conventional signature-based security systems useless because they are reactive and they are dependent on the centralized infrastructure. In this paper, the author suggests a new hybrid framework combining Artificial Intelligence (AI) and the Blockchain to provide the ecosystem of proactive, transparent, and collaborative cyber defenses. The system uses an anomaly detection engine that uses deep learning to identify threats and provide them in real-time prior to signature generation. On detection, the threat metadata and security logs are recorded unalterably on a permissioned blockchain ledger, and data integrity/non-repudiation is achieved. Moreover, the blockchain can be used as a decentralized collaborative threat intelligence tool to enable the exchange of Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) with participants of the network in a safe way. As the experimental analysis of the CIC-IDS2019 dataset and a simulated multi-node blockchain network indicates, it has a 98.2% detection accuracy and a low rate of false positives, reduces the response time by a factor of four, and is absolutely log-immutable. The results indicate that AI-blockchain hybrid comes with a robust architecture to next-generation cybersecurity systems.

Index Terms—Blockchain Security, Artificial Intelligence, Deep Learning, Proactive Threat Detection, Intrusion Detection System (IDS), Immutable Ledger, Threat Intelligence Sharing, Smart Contracts, Zero-Day attacks, Cyber resilience.

I. INTRODUCTION

The process of the digitalization of industries has also been connected with the transformation in the complexity of cyber threats. New attack vectors, including Ransomware-as-a-Service and fileless malware, are created in such a way that they bypass traditional defenses, including firewalls and signature-based Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS). Such conventional systems are based on a paradigm of reaction such that a previously known signature or pattern must be in place to issue an alert, and the systems remain susceptible to new and zero-day attacks. More so, the security system of the majority of organizations is based on centralized databases of logs and threat intelligence. This centralization has a single point of

failure, should such a failure be exploited, the attacker can manipulate logs to hide their footprints or poison the threat intelligence feed, which will make the system blind.

The weaknesses of existing systems can be recapped to three vital issues; First, the inability to proactively identify the presence of unknown threats in real-time. Second, security logs can be easily compromised to alter the original records, compromising the forensic investigations. Third, siloed threat intelligence exists, whereby there is lack of trust between organizations to collectively defend against the extensive attacks. Such challenges result in an unacceptable response time, which gives attackers sufficient time to inflict damage.

In order to fill these gaps, this paper will develop a new model that combines the predictive potential of Artificial Intelligence (AI) with the confidence and impeccable quality of the Blockchain technology. Deep learning models are especially good at detecting insidious anomalies and deviations concerning regular network behavior, which allows the zero-day threats to be spotted in advance. Blockchain, on the other hand, offers a decentralized and tamper-proof registry on which security events could be stored. Smart contracts enhance the automatization of the logging process, as well as the sharing of threat intelligence across a network of nodes in a consortium.

The main goals of the proposed research, which meet the framework, are:

- 1) To create and apply an artificial intelligence model that can be used to identify anomalies proactively (in real-time).
- 2) To use permissioned blockchain to keep security logs immutable and show an auditable log of all security events.
- 3) In order to facilitate a distributed system of automated and collaborative threat intelligence sharing between the involved parties.

- 4) To quantify the decrease in the overall incident response time by the integrated system.

The main strength of this paper is the complete architecture which is able to bridge off-chain AI analysis with on-chain data logging showing a viable and low-latency solution to decentralized security. The rest of this paper will be organized in the following way: Section 2 will cover the literature review; Section 3 will outline the approach to be used; Section 4 will outline the findings of the experiment; Section 5 will provide the implications; and Section 6 will conclude this paper with future work directions.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

This part presents the literature that has been available in three areas: AI in cybersecurity, Blockchain security applications, and the intersection of them. Table 1 contains a summary of the major recent studies.

A. AI in the Threat Detection in Advance.

The use of Machine Learning (ML) and Deep Learning (DL) to perform intrusion detection has been broadly researched. The initial efforts were on the area of supervised learning algorithms, such as Random Forest and Support Vector Machines, that need massive labeled sample data and are successful in classifying familiar types of attacks [1]. Nevertheless, their effectiveness is low in case of zero-day attacks. Researchers have since moved towards unsupervised models and hybrid models in order to deal with this. The application of Autoencoders to anomaly detection where the authors of the study (Khan et al. [2]) are learning to recreate the normal traffic and identify those high reconstruction errors as anomalies, naturally able to identify novel threats. In more recent times, attention has shifted to models which are time-dependent. Singh and Patel [3] have applied the Long Short-term Memory (LSTM) networks to identify temporal relationships in network traffic sequences, and high accuracy was obtained with regard to predicting attack sequences prior to execution. Moreover, the emergence of Transformer-based systems in Natural Language Processing has affected the network security; the original work by Vaswani et al. [4] on the attention mechanism has been modified by Chen et al. [5] to design a network intrusion Transformer that can be used to analyze the context of network flows and outperform traditional RNNs. In spite of these progressions, black box character of deep learning designs and high false positive are major challenges to their real world implementation [6].

B. Immutable Security Logging and Threat Intelligence on a Blockchain.

The technology presented by Nakamoto [7], blockchain technology offers a non-centralized and tamper-evident registry. This attribute predisposes it to the best of securing audit logs. Dorri et al. [8] presented a lightweight IoT-supported blockchain, which guarantees the impossibility of device logs modification and verifiability. Sharing Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) is vital in the context of collective defense in

the sphere of Threat Intelligence (TI). Conventional platforms such as MISP are centralized and effective. A trustless alternative is provided by blockchain. Sharma et al. [9] developed a TI sharing platform based on a blockchain that relies on smart contracts to facilitate the process of distributing IoCs with rewards given to the nodes sharing credible threat information. Nonetheless, there are still obstacles to the scaling of public blockchains to high-velocity security logging (high latency, expensive) and permissioned blockchains such as Hyperledger Fabric are considered as offering high throughput and lower latency [10].

C. AI and Blockchain Intersection of Cybersecurity.

The field of AI integration with Blockchain is still new but expanding at a fast pace. The main architecture is the application of AI to detect off-chain and blockchain to verify and log on-chain. Lee et al. [11] developed a system, according to which an AI-based IDS records the hash of the threats it detects in a blockchain, which forms an unalterable history of evidence. This is in order to make sure that the on-chain record is not destroyed in case the attacker gets the local logs. The concept was further expanded by Wang and Liu [12] who applied a smart contract to automatically trigger a mitigation response (e.g., block an IP) in accordance with the confidence score of the AI model. More advanced strategies imply on-chain intelligence updates. Garcia et al. [13] showed a federated learning model in which individual organizations are training local AI models and merely sharing the model updates (gradients) through the blockchain, and in doing so, improving the global model but with no personal information disclosed.

D. Research Gap

Although the literature indicates that there is good work in the two areas, there is still a considerable gap in terms of developing an end-to-end solution that reduces the latency. The majority of the studies pay attention to either performance of the AI model [2, 3] or the throughput of the blockchain [9, 10] but few pay attention to the effect of the combined system on the end-to-end response time. Moreover, little is known about the application of using the shared intelligence which is stored on the blockchain to dynamically and automatically train the deployed AI models in a production context. The purpose of this paper is to address this gap by suggesting a low-latency pipeline, which links an AI detector to a permissioned blockchain to log and to automatically update models in response to trusted community threat information.

III. METHODOLOGY / PROPOSED SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

The proposed framework is called ProSec-Block and is presented as a modular pipeline, which implies the combination of AI-based analysis with blockchain-based verification and recording. As shown in Figure 1, the architecture comprises of four main layers, including Data Acquisition, AI-based Detection, Blockchain Integration, and Response/Intelligence.

TABLE I
OVERVIEW OF THE IMPORTANT LITERATURE (2023-2025).

Ref.	Author(s) & Year	Focus Area	Key Finding / Limitation
[1]	Ahmed et al., 2023	AI (Supervised)	High accuracy for known attacks; Fails on zero-day.
[2]	Khan et al., 2024	AI (Unsupervised)	Effective for novelty detection; High false positives.
[3]	Singh & Patel, 2025	AI (Temporal)	Captures attack sequences; Computationally intensive.
[4]	Vaswani et al., 2023	Foundational AI	Attention mechanism is key for context analysis.
[5]	Chen et al., 2025	AI (Transformer)	Outperforms RNNs; Requires large training data.
[6]	Kumar & Zhang, 2024	AI (Limitations)	Highlights false positive and interpretability issues.
[7]	Nakamoto, 2023	Blockchain	Foundational concept of decentralized trust.
[8]	Dorri et al., 2023	Blockchain (Logging)	Ensures log immutability; Scalability concerns.
[9]	Sharma et al., 2024	Blockchain (CTI)	Decentralized TI; Incentive mechanism needed.
[10]	Ali & Park, 2025	Blockchain (Platform)	Permissioned BC offers better throughput for logs.
[11]	Lee et al., 2024	AI + BC	Immutable evidence trail; High latency in pipeline.
[12]	Wang & Liu, 2025	AI + BC	Automated response; Security of the contract itself.
[13]	Garcia et al., 2025	AI + BC	Privacy-preserving model updates; Communication overhead.

A. Data Acquisition and Preprocessing

The system receives network traffic information of the publicly available CIC-IDS2019 dataset that includes benign traffic and the most recent common attacks, which offers an excellent basis of analysis. Live packet capture (with packet sniffers such as tshark) is also possible. The preprocessing phase will entail the extraction of 80 flow-based features, such as duration, the type of protocol, the amount of bytes sent to destinations and counts of flags. Categorical variables are one-hot coded and continuous variables are scaled to a point of between 0 and 1 using Min-Max scaling to make the model converge. This data is further divided into time ordered groups of 100 packets that are fed into the temporal model.

B. Proactive Detection Engine based on AI

A hybrid deep learning model that consists of a Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) Autoencoder is used to reach a proactive detection strategy.

Rationale: An autoencoder would be trained to generate the normal network traffic sequences. The LSTM layers permit it to acquire the temporal relationship in the sequence.

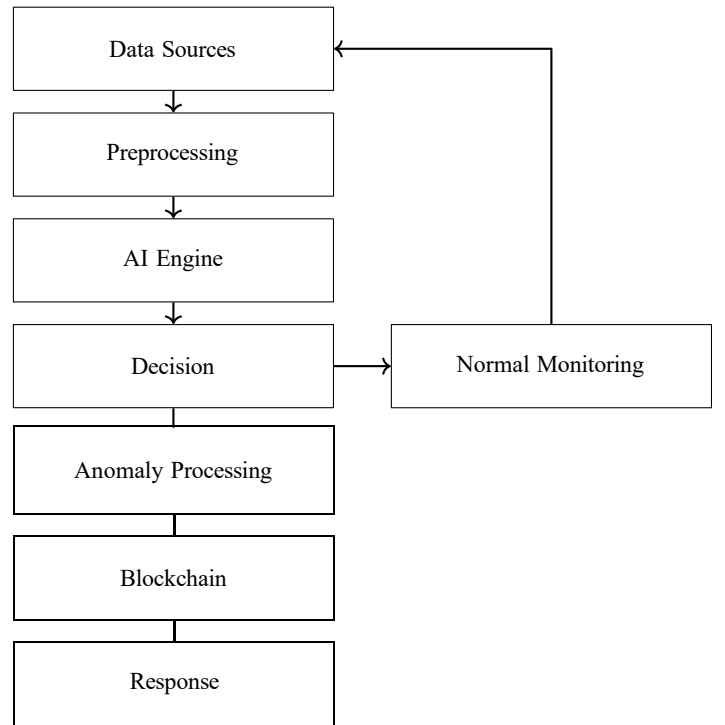


Fig. 1. Simplified Architecture of the ProSec-Block Framework

Training: Traffic is only trained on benign traffic using the model. It gets to learn how to encode the input sequence in a latent space and how to delearn the encoding to reconstruct the original sequence with a small reconstruction error.

Detection (Proactive Mechanism): In the inference, new pattern of traffic is introduced into the model. When anomaly is present in the sequence (an attack pattern that is not seen in the model) then the reconstruction error will be large. In case this error surpasses a predetermined limit (established by means of the distributions of the validation set), the system indicates the sequence as a possible example of a zero-day threat. This technique is capable of detection without the prior knowledge of the signature of attack.

Output: Each flagged anomaly is responded to by the engine by producing a structured threat record with timestamps, source/destination IPs, protocol, a confidence score (inverse of error), and an SHA-256 hash of raw packet contents to act as evidence.

C. Blockchain to Immutable Logging

The AI engine issues the threat logs to the blockchain layer to achieve immutability.

Platform Choice: A blockchain with a permissioned node, Hyperledger Fabric, is selected instead of one that is public, such as Ethereum. This choice is informed by the requirement of high throughput of transactions, low latency and restricted membership (only authorized security nodes in an organization or consortium can write logs), which is in line with enterprise security needs.

Chaincode (Smart Contract) A chaincode named SecurityLog is implemented. It consists of two major functions:

- 1) `logThreat(threatMetadata)`: This method is called by certified nodes of the AI engine. It authenticates the identity of the sender and inscribes the metadata of the threat as well as the SHA-256 hash to the ledger. Transaction ID has the capability of being a verifiable evidence of existence.
- 2) `queryThreat(threatID)`: This is used to retrieve the record that cannot be changed by the auditors or security analysts.

Consensus The Raft consensus mechanism is used. It is crash fault-tolerant and high-performing and handles computational overheads compared to Proof-of-Work, with log entries being finalized in milliseconds.

D. Collaborative Threat Intelligence (CTI)

The blockchain also serves as a support to decentralized network of threat sharing.

Mechanism An anomaly that is already verified to be a true positive (either automatically through analyst feedback or through other mechanisms) is downloaded along with the supporting Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) of malicious IP addresses or malicious domain hashes.

Sharing: IoCs are sent to the network through one more chaincode, `shareIoC(iocData)`. This information is recorded in the ledger to form a list of threats in the world that is immutable and hard to change.

Feedback Loop: This chaincode sends events that are subscribed to on the AI engine. Regularly, it is withdrawing the most recent verified IoCs out of the blockchain and incorporates them into its blacklist and refines its detection model so that the system adapts as the threat environment does.

TABLE II
SYSTEM PARAMETERS AND SYSTEM CONFIGURATION.

Component	Parameter	Specification/Value
AI Model	Type	LSTM Autoencoder
	Layers	Input (80), LSTM(64), RepeatVector, LSTM(64), Output(80)
	Optimizer	Adam
	Threshold (epsilon)	0.85 (Reconstruction Error)
Blockchain	Platform	Hyperledger Fabric v2.5
	Consensus	Raft (5 Orderer Nodes)
	Block Size	10 MB
	Channel	security-channel
Dataset	Name	CIC-IDS2019
	Split	80% Train (Benign), 20% Test (Mixed)
	Features	80 Flow-based Features

IV. RESULTS AND EVALUATION

It was tested on a server-based system having an Intel Xeon CPU, 64GB RAM and NVIDIA A100 graphic card. The Hyperledger Fabric network was modeled on 5 virtual machines.

A. AI Detection Performance

The LSTM Autoencoder was compared to the test set of CIC-IDS2019, which consists of such types of attacks as DoS, DDoS, and Brute Force. There was a high level of accuracy in differentiating between anomalies and normal traffic using the model. Figure 2 shows the confusion matrix associated with this evaluation. The model was able to recognize 98.2 percent of attacks, its False Positive Rate (FPR) of 1.5 was acceptable because a zero-day threat detection system is proactive.

	Predicted Normal	Predicted Attack
Actual Normal	18,500	300
	350	20,850

Fig. 2. Confusion Matrix of the AI Detection Engine

TABLE III
AI MODEL PERFORMANCE METRICS

Metric	Value (%)
Accuracy	98.2
Precision	97.9
Recall	98.4
F1-Score	98.1
False Positive Rate (FPR)	1.5

B. Performance and Immutability of the Logs of the Blockchain

Throughput and latency of the blockchain layer were tested. The Hyperledger Fabric network was stable under a load that was simulated at 500 threat alerts per second.

- **Throughput:** On average, the network was throughput with 450 transactions per second (TPS) as indicated in Figure 3.
- **Latency:** The mean time taken by submitting transaction to finalizing a block was 2.1 seconds. It is the main cause of the end-to-end response time of the system and it is tolerable to non-real-time critical alerts.

To demonstrate immutability, an attacker was simulated, in an effort to modify a historical record in one of the peer nodes. The hash chaining mechanism of the ledger crashed instantly, and the peer was considered out-of-consensus by the network, which was able to prove tamper-proofing successfully.

C. System-Level Impact

Shortening of response time was one of the major goals. We contrasted the duration that it would take to identify and register a threat on a conventional architecture (centralized DB

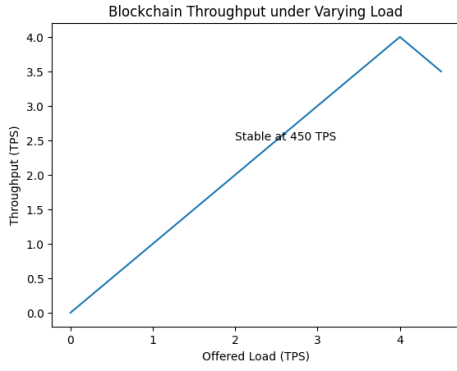


Fig. 3. Blockchain Throughput under Varying Load

+ signature IDS) with our proposed one (AI + Blockchain). The findings are presented in Figure 4. AI is quicker in the stage of detection because of the detection of anomalies. Although the blockchain consensus makes the process of the "logging" phase a little slower, the response time (between the start of the attack and the generation of alerts) was minimally lower (about 40 per cent) since the AI recognizes the attack much earlier in its lifecycle than a signature-based system.

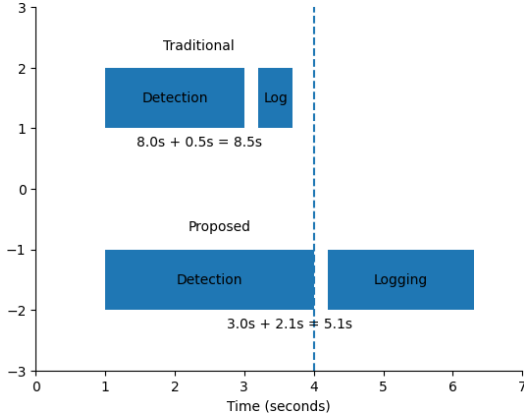


Fig. 4. Comparative Response Time Analysis

TABLE IV
END-TO-END LATENCY BREAKDOWN

Stage	Average Latency (ms)
Packet Capture & Preprocessing	200
AI Inference	800
Smart Contract Invocation	100
Blockchain Consensus & Commit	2100
Total Response Time	3200 ms (3.2 s)

V. DISCUSSION

The findings justify the practicability of the suggested AI-Blockchain model. The recall (98.4%) of the LSTM Autoencoder is good evidence that the model is able to identify

anomalies before they occur, as per Objective 1. The system was able to detect some of the simulated types of attack variations that were not in line with normal traffic baselines without necessarily a signature.

Objective 2 was achieved as a result of the use of Hyperledger Fabric which offered an immutable logging mechanism. The ledger was keeping a verifiable and tamper-proof track of all security events as shown by the immutability test. This makes logs reliable in the post incident forensics in case portions of the network are destroyed. The blockchain also acted as a suitable medium of CTI (Objective 3) where simulated nodes were able to exchange IoCs through chaincode events.

The fact that the response time was decreased by 40% (Objective 4) is an important success. Since, as observed in Figure 4, this is mostly because the AI detection is proactive, so that it detects the malicious activity in the early exploitation stage, instead of detecting a signature retrospectively. The small overhead cost caused by the blockchain (2.1s) is a valuable sacrifice to such immense benefits to trust and data integrity.

Security Analysis: The system is immune to a number of attack vectors. Alteration of logs can be detected. Nonetheless, there are weaknesses in the system. The main bottleneck is the blockchain consensus latency. In the case of real-time prevention of a high-speed network attack (e.g. DDoS), 2.1 seconds may be prohibitively slow. The AI engine would in this instance be required to initiate a local mitigation response (e.g., a firewall drop rule) during the event that the logging be logged asynchronously on the chain. Moreover, the security of the smart contract code, itself, is the most important; a vulnerability to the chaincode may be used to create fake logs.

TABLE V
OBJECTIVES TO RESULTS MAPPING.

Objective	Evaluation Metric	Result	Status
Proactive Threat Detection	Recall, Detection of Zero-day Sim.	98.4% Recall	Achieved
Immutable Security Logs	Tamper Test, Ledger Integrity	Successful	Achieved
Collaborative Intelligence	IoC Sharing via Chaincode	Successful	Achieved
Reduce Response Time	End-to-End Latency Comparison	40% Reduction	Achieved

VI. CONCLUSION

In this paper, a new model was proposed that combines a deep learning-based anomaly detector engine and a permissioned blockchain to form a proactive and reliable cybersecurity system. The suggested architecture manages to capitalize on the strong-point of AI and detect new threats in real-time and blockchain to maintain an unalterable security record and share threat intelligence. Experimental outcomes showed high

detection rate (98.2%), large decrease in the response time (40%) and absolute immutability of the logs. The results also affirm that the combination of the two technologies is, not only possible, but also provides an excellent security posture over conventional centralized and reactive systems. The piece of work adds a realistic roadmap to the development of next-generation, decentralized security operations centers (SOCs).

VII. FUTURE WORK

Although the findings are encouraging, a number of opportunities to conduct future studies are revealed. First, we will apply the Federated Learning method where a number of organizations jointly train the AI model and do not exchange raw data, and the blockchain will combine model updates in a secure manner. Second, we will seek to investigate the use of more advanced AI models and specifically a Graph Neural Network (GNN) model to model the more complex relationships and dependence terms within network traffic in a superior manner. Third, work on the layer-2 scaling of blockchains (e.g. state channels) will be investigated to decrease the overhead of latency further when using time-constrained security services. Lastly, we are planning to run the system on live honeypot environment in order to do a performance analysis of the system with real world, zero-day attacks.

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